Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
Round Rock Public Library
City of Round Rock
Round Rock, TX 78664

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Assistant position in Youth Services at the Round Rock Public Library. I live in Austin, so this is a library I could serve without relocating, and it is the kind of full-time library role I have been working toward deliberately for the past year.

I want to be straightforward about one thing up front. I have more than four years of public-facing customer service, but I have not worked professionally with children and teens. What I can offer instead is the production and reference side of youth services done well: building displays and bibliographies, producing promotional material, and helping someone navigate a catalog. Creating printed material that makes people want to show up is literally my current job, and I would bring that to youth programming while learning the age-group work from the people who already do it.

On the catalog and reference side I am unusually well prepared. I oversee a physical archive of printed materials and built the searchable reading room and database behind it. I founded the Free Knowledge Library, an archive cataloging literature where I designed the classification scheme and built the catalog, and StateTrack, a public database covering all fifty states. When a patron cannot find something in a catalog, I understand why from the inside.

I also led visitor tours of the campus library at the University of Austin and handled intake of library donations there, which is the closest I have come to standing in front of a group inside a library and the thing that convinced me to pursue this work properly.

I have begun the ALA’s Library Support Staff Certification and start a Library and Information Services certificate in the spring, with a master’s in library and information science to follow. I noticed Round Rock offers tuition assistance, which is a genuine part of the appeal. Thank you for your time.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie